

# NYC-Style Bagels

Straight dough · short ~3h bulk → shape → **emphasized pan proof** → cold hold · boiled & baked

| YIELD            | FLOUR                         | HYDRATION  | METHOD                     | TOTAL DOUGH    |
|------------------|-------------------------------|------------|----------------------------|----------------|
| <b>24 @ 150g</b> | <b>Sir Lancelot<br/>14.2%</b> | <b>60%</b> | <b>Straight +<br/>bulk</b> | <b>~3,630g</b> |

## STRAIGHT DOUGH

No poolish — mix it all at once

|                                    |                |               |               |
|------------------------------------|----------------|---------------|---------------|
| Sir Lancelot                       | <b>2,200 g</b> | Honey (~2.5%) | <b>55 g</b>   |
| Water (60% — cold if warm kitchen) | <b>1,320 g</b> | ADY (0.6%)    | <b>13.2 g</b> |
| Salt (2%)                          | <b>44 g</b>    |               |               |

The flour's malted barley supplies the enzyme load. **0.6% ADY targets a ~4.5h total room ferment** (~3h bulk + ~1.5h pan proof) — ~6× the pizza 0.2% because this runs ~5× faster. Derived against the TXCraig1 yeast model at a granite-cooled ~66°F effective bulk temp. Start here; if the bulk hits 50% well before 3h, drop toward 0.4% — if it drags, the granite's colder than figured, nudge up or extend.

## MIX

Two batches — incorporation only, then fold

Mix straight, then divide by weight for the stretch-and-fold. Each batch makes 12 bagels.

### PER MIXING BATCH ×2

|       |                |
|-------|----------------|
| Flour | <b>1,100 g</b> |
| Water | <b>660 g</b>   |
| Salt  | <b>22 g</b>    |
| Honey | <b>27.5 g</b>  |
| ADY   | <b>6.6 g</b>   |

**Mixer = incorporation only.** At 60% with 14.2% flour the hook can't reach windowpane — gluten's too strong to fully develop in the machine. Run low just until combined, no dry bits, then stop.

**Develop by stretch-and-fold:** after the mix, **bench rest 20–30 min** — it relaxes and hydrates the dough so the first fold actually develops it. Then **2–3 S&F sets ~30 min apart** through the first ~1.5h of bulk; the rests relax it, the folds build the network. **Windowpane is a post-fold check.**

~1,815g dough per batch → 12 bagels @ 150g.

**The consistency lever:** shaping from a **bulk-fermented mass** — not pre-divided pieces — is why pro bagels come out even without a scale. A short bulk organizes the gluten across the whole dough so each piece ropes uniformly. This is the structural reason for the fork.

## TEMP TARGETS

this stage — mix & dough

|                         |             |                 |                 |
|-------------------------|-------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| Room (dough rests here) | <b>70°F</b> | Dough after mix | <b>~68–70°F</b> |
|-------------------------|-------------|-----------------|-----------------|

# Execution

| ROOM<br>(BULK+PROOF) | BULK PULL | BOIL BATH  | BAKE  |
|----------------------|-----------|------------|-------|
| 70°F                 | ~50% rise | 212°F roll | 450°F |

## BULK · SHAPE · PROOF · HOLD

- 1 Short bulk, ~3 h:** mix in the morning, then **bench rest 20–30 min** before folding. Bulk on the counter **to ~50% rise**; run **2–3 S&F sets, 30 min apart**, through the first ~1.5 h. The bulk's job is to **organize the gluten**, not the main proof — pull by rise, not clock.
- 2 Divide from the bulk** to 150g (cut from the organized mass — the consistency move). Pre-round, bench rest **10–15 min**, then **rope & weld TIGHT**: fuse the seam on un-floured counter, small ~1.5" hole = puffs up, not out.
- 3 Pan proof — THIS is the main proof, ~1–2 h:** rise the shaped bagels on half-sheets at 70°F **to final height**. This is the rise that makes the bagel; weight it here, not in the bulk. Float-test when they look ready.
- 4 Fridge = HOLD, not proof.** Bagels go in **already proofed**; expect ~no rise (this fridge doesn't proof). Cold-hold for flavor + scheduling, then boil straight from cold (brief temper for the chill).

**Granite note:** cold counter is a heat-sink — it slows the bulk (good, keeps it partial) but unevenly. Bulk in a **bowl** for even temp if you want; the pan proof runs warmer (pan buffers the counter) which is why it finishes the rise.

## BROWNING MECHANISM

Honey-only bath — golden, not mahogany

Honey deposits a sugar film → **Maillard** fuel for color and flavor. **Baking soda is out:** the alkali browned faster (pretzel chemistry) but set a **thicker, tougher skin** that pulls away from the crumb — the same delamination that sheds everything-seasoning when you cut. Without it the crust bakes **thinner and more tender, but lighter — golden, not the deep mahogany that needs barley malt**. Malt is the real color + flavor fix when it's on hand.

## DIAGNOSTICS

|                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dull, soft, over-sprung                       | Under-boiled — skin never set. Add boil time.                                                                                                                                                    |
| Wrinkled, tough, squat, gummy ring under skin | Over-boiled — skin set too hard, strangled spring. Cut boil time.                                                                                                                                |
| Skin right, interior gummy                    | Under-baked. Add 2–3 min; leave boil alone.                                                                                                                                                      |
| Tough bite, tight crumb                       | Under-proofed. Extend the bulk or the shaped room-temp rise; the fridge won't proof it. Float-test before boiling.                                                                               |
| Tough, dried heel                             | Bottom heat too aggressive — <b>skip the pizza steel</b> (it dumps too much heat). Start on the <b>wet boards</b> , then <b>flip onto a stone or pan</b> ; a gentler deck keeps the heel tender. |
| Tough crumb, worse when toasted               | Moisture-starved — <b>60% is the tenderness floor</b> .                                                                                                                                          |